was scared of Sir and ended up not saying a word about batting on for another over.

I duly declared the innings and, despite having batted for a day and a half, went on to open the bowling with the new ball and bowled a lot of overs in the innings. I did not feel the least bit tired; all the hard work in the summer camps had started to pay off. I started out bowling medium pace, then changed to off-spin when the ball was semi-old and leg-spin when the ball had lost all of its shine. Vinod too bowled very well and picked up six wickets as we dismissed St Xavier's for 154 to make the final.

That partnership of 664 was the highest in any form of cricket in the world at the time. Coming in the semi-final of the Harris Shield made it all the more significant in the local cricket community. It gained us both a lot of recognition. We had become quite a pair and what made batting with Vinod fun was that I never knew what he'd get up to next. In one match in the same season he actually started flying a kite while we were batting together. Suddenly I couldn't see Vinod, because he had walked 20 metres away from the pitch and was holding the string of a kite – right in the middle of the innings! It was his way of enjoying himself and I knew he'd get a severe reprimand from Sir for doing so.

Sir wasn't to be seen on that day, however, and Vinod was confident of getting away with it. I wasn't so sure. I had a feeling that Sir was watching us from somewhere and would surely pick up the issue at the end of the day's play, as was his style. Sir was known to hide behind a tree on occasions to watch us play, and in fact it rarely happened that he'd miss a game of ours. At the end of the day he would then give us a 'demonstration' session, so called because Sir would demonstrate what we had done wrong in terms of footwork, stance or stroke selection. Sure enough, at the demonstration session at the end of that day, I was given a chit to read aloud and the first item was 'Vinod kite'. Sir, upset at what Vinod had done, asked him what he thought he was doing flying a kite while batting and warned him never to do so again. He promised, but with Vinod nothing could be taken for granted.

Having defeated St Xavier's comprehensively, we were runaway favourites in the final against Anjuman-I-Islam, which was to be played at the Cricket Club of India, which is India's equivalent of the MCC, established in 1933. It was my first competitive game at CCI and a number of Mumbai cricket luminaries were present to see us bat in the